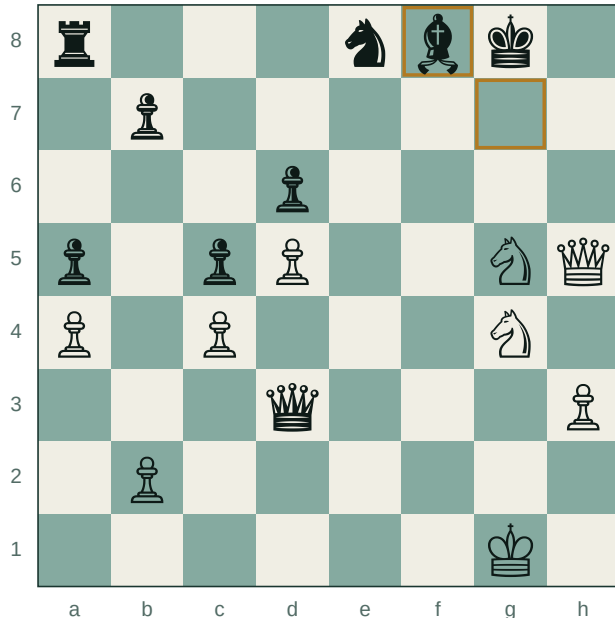


Deflection tactics: White, move 35

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 34...Bxf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Qf7+ Kh8 36. Qxf8#

35.Qf7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f7 it attacks king on g8, knight on e8 and bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **35...Kh8**.

36.Qxf8# Mate: queen on f8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on f8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on d3. Check for tactical protection.